Bicycle Maintenance Manual: Tires and Brakes

1. Fixing a Flat Tire

A flat tire is the most common bicycle issue.

Step 1: Remove the wheel from the bike.

Step 2: Use tire levers to pry one side of the tire off the rim.

Step 3: Remove the old inner tube and find the puncture. Also check the inside of the tire for thorns or glas

Step 4: Slightly inflate the new inner tube and place it inside the tire.

Step 5: Seat the tire back onto the rim and inflate to the recommended PSI printed on the tire sidewall.

2. Adjusting Brake Pads

Brake pads must hit the rim squarely to be effective.

Step 1: Loosen the brake pad bolt using an Allen key.

Step 2: Align the pad so it is flat against the rim braking surface.

Step 3: Ensure it does not touch the tire, which can cause a blowout.

Step 4: Tighten the bolt securely.